

JULY 16-31, 1980

was the Government doing all these years? Nonetheless, Modi's downfall was imminent. He had started considering himself indispensable and felt that the IPL brand could not survive without him. In Modi's case, the process of his downfall has been accelerated because he dared to take on powerful people within the Government.

AMBAR MALLICK, *Kolkata*

Check Points

With corruption having ensnared Indian consulates to an extent that there are horrific reports of Indian visas being available for a price, it is not surprising that terrorists like David Coleman Headley and Tahawwur Hussain Rana had a free run in the country ("Inside Out", May 3). The pressing need of the hour is to rid the consulates of corruption. If the Ministry of External Affairs is unable to take on the onerous task of doing a thorough background check of personnel posted to the consulates, it should take the Ministry of Home Affairs on board to conduct verification.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Tweeting Trouble

Shashi Tharoor isn't a misfit in Indian politics just because a bunch of private individuals are staking their equity on his love interest, with or without his bidding ("Mr Misfit",

April 26). It is the patent incompatibility between his freewheeling style and the conformist culture of the Congress that has rendered him helpless. When a senior leader like P. Chidambaram can be accused of 'intellectual arrogance', what chance would a newcomer have who, apart from having intellectual credentials, makes his presence felt through irreverent tweets.

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

average Indian citizen would feel mortified at the prospect of channelling money for appeasing any religion for the sake of votebank politics when our farmers are committing suicide for not being able to pay their loans.

SALINI JOHNSON,
via www.indiatoday.in

Nailing the Naxals

Dealing with Naxals and addressing the problems of hunger, poverty and neglect of the tribals are two different issues which

HEMANT CHAWLA/www.indiatodayimages.com



“The suicide of a gay professor has besmirched the reputation of Aligarh Muslim University. The university's functionaries and the student council must come together to stall its further fall.”

V.K. TANGRI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Minority Interests

It was appalling to hear that a whopping Rs 941 crore was granted as Haj subsidy during 2009-2010 in India ("The Haj Haggles", April 26). It is wrong to render huge amount of money for religious purposes in a nation known for its ethnic diversity. An

need to be taken up differently but with a common goal of elimination ("Declare War", April 19). The might of the state must be applied to eliminate the Maoists while the resources of the state must be used to eliminate hunger, poverty and neglect of the tribals.

M.C. JOSHI, *Lucknow*

Crisis of Identity

They had begun to arrive here in droves—in the early '60s. Students, businessmen and travellers had taken advantage of the newly relaxed immigration quotas and transformed themselves into immigrants. They had encouraged their relatives to join their already swelling ranks. They had flocked to America's centres of learning, some to Harvard and MIT, some to Michigan, others to Washington's mostly black Howard University, from where they emerged as engineers and technicians. For more than a decade they had led the charmed life of the privileged of the earth to whom air conditioners and houses and cars came as if ordained by a natural order of things. They had breezed through their 20s, never looking back, becoming an integral part of the American dream of two cars in every garage, two chickens in every cooking pot. They had wrought a small economic miracle for themselves, these young scientists, bureaucrats, doctors and business analysts of Indian origin. Air fares were cheap then. Cheap enough to enable them to fly home, to India, find brides, plunge into quickly arranged marriage ceremonies and fly back to work in America the following week.

by Inderjit Badhwar

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